The Effect of Having Daughters on Gender Equality Attitudes and Political Preferences

This pre-analysis plan outlines the methodology for testing four hypotheses regarding the impact of having daughters on parental attitudes toward gender equality, political preferences, and household behavior using the German Socio-Economic Panel (SOEP) data. The study will examine whether parents with daughters demonstrate stronger support for gender equality, more left-leaning political preferences, and more egalitarian household arrangements compared to parents without daughters.

Research Objectives

The primary objective is to test the "daughter effect", the hypothesized influence of having daughters on parental attitudes and behaviors related to gender equality and political orientation. This research contributes to understanding the mechanisms through which family composition affects political socialization and attitude formation.

Hypotheses

H1. Having daughters leads to stronger support for gender equality.

H2. Having daughters leads to more left-leaning political preferences.

H3. Having daughters leads to more gender equality in the household.

H4. Having daughters leads to a larger increase in support of gender equality for men than for women.

Dependent Variable

- Gender Equality Index (H1 & H4): Construct a binary Gender Equality Index using responses to Q362 and Q363, which ask how unpleasant it is if a man or a woman earns less than colleagues in the same job. If the respondent gives the same score on the Likert scale to both questions (indicating equal concern for both genders), code as 1. If the responses differ, code it as 0.

- Political Preferences (H2): Composite score derived from the average value of responses for Q81, Q82, and Q83 (Reverse coded). First, code the response in binary. With 1 for “favorable” answers for Q81 and Q82 and “against” in the case of Q83, while 0 for “against” responses for Q81, Q82, and “favorable” answers for Q83. The average of three binary-coded responses will give positive continuous data.
- Gender disparity at home (H3): Response from Q212 will be coded binary. If childcare hours per day is above eight then 1, otherwise 0.

Independent Variable

- Daughter (DX): A binary variable of having a daughter or not. 1 in case the respondent has at least one daughter and 0 for either no daughter or no child. Use responses on Q 239 and Q 242.

Control Variables

- Financial Satisfaction (FS): The response about satisfaction with household income. The response value from Q 66.
- Life Satisfaction (LS): The response about the satisfaction from life. The response value from Q 481.
- Gender Discrimination (GD): The response about Gender discrimination experienced by respondents. The response of Q 97 (Gender) will be coded 0 for not experiencing and 1 for experiencing.
- Sibling (S): The response of Q 184, coded as binary data; if the respondent has a sister, then 1; if not, then 0.
- Self Education (Ed): The response of Q 289, coded as binary data, 1 if the respondent is graduated, 0 if not.
- Religious (R): The response of Q 444, coded as binary data, 1 if the respondent belongs to a religious community, 0 if not.
- Parent Stay (P): The response of Q 425, coded as binary data, is 1 if at least one parent is living and 0 if neither parent is living here in the household.

Inclusion/exclusion criteria:

- Individuals living with their partner.
- Born in germany, not migrated.
- Married.

Exact analysis:

- GLM will be used
    - For H1, H3 and H4: Binomial family and logit link function.
    - For H2: Gaussian family with identity link function.
- For each hypothesis, we will have two models: the Male respondent Main effect (MM) model and the Female respondent Main effect (FM) model.

Interpretation of results:

- For H1, if coefficient values of DX in both MM and FM models are positive and significant, then we accept the H1.
- For H2, if the coefficient values of DX in both MM and FM models are positive and significant, then we accept the H2.
- For H3, if the coefficient values of DX in both MM and FM models are positive and significant, then we accept the H3.
- For H4, we will test whether the difference in the DX coefficients between the MM and FM is statistically significant using a z-test. We will accept H4, if $|z| \geq 1.96$.